This December, the Kochi-Muziris Biennale will unfold across multiple venues in Kochi, Kerala. Titled *For the Time Being*, it is curated by multidisciplinary artist Nikhil Chopra, along with his Goa-based artist-led organisation HH Art Spaces. "We are placing the body at the centre of our investigation. Everything originates from the body, transforming it into the artwork, and from there to the viewer. There is a transference that moves through these bodies, and we are particularly interested in this transformation and transfer," elaborates Chopra. Many artists are creating live and performance work that will unfold over the 110 days of the Biennale: Mandeep Rekhi will be performing with his dance company Sandbox; Anja Ibsch from Germany will spend the entire duration of the exhibition in her space, actively making her work in the moment; and Berlin-based Iraqi artist Hiwa K. will present a series of performances called *Chicago Boys*, working with amateur musicians to create original songs that address community issues.

The title *For the Time Being* suggests a pause, a moment of attention. This idea of temporality flows through the works at the Biennale. For example, Panjeri Artists' Union, based between Kolkata and Delhi, will be exhibiting daily objects from existing households and returning them after the four months of the exhibition. "The Biennale in its very essence, is a punctuation in any given landscape where art is both given space and practised. Hence, the idea of what a Biennale should be, immediately identifies it as a gathering that is suspended in time; something that is away from museumification of contemporary art—teaching us how we don't have to adhere to permanence as the only way," says artist Madhurjya Dey of HH Art Spaces.

The Biennale is also highly place-specific, with nearly half the participating artists having visited Kochi in recent months, engaging with local conditions while developing their installations. "We've worked hard to move away from constructing white cube spaces, even removing false walls and avoiding sterilised environments. Instead, we've embraced the history of the spaces, allowing peeling walls and textures to become part of the narrative. The exhibition isn't about creating a sanitised environment but about encouraging a reactive approach," says Chopra. Many artists have also

**THIS YEAR'S BIENNALE INCLUDES SEVER FIRST-TIME VENU , WITH THE EVENTS EXTENDING INTO THE LIFE OF THE CITY**

FESTIVAL ▶

# A Date with Serendipity

**The multidisciplinary festival in Goa will see over 250 programmes across 10 days**

**There's always a reason to visit Goa but this December, there's an even better one. The Serendipity Arts Festival, one of South Asia's biggest multidisciplinary festivals, is returning there in its largest avatar yet. In its tenth edition there are over 250 multidisciplinary programmes taking place from December 12 to 21.**

**Says Smriti Rajgarhia, director of Serendipity Arts, "The festival is more than an initiative. It is a movement, a living space where art bridges divides and brings people together. For over a decade, we've**





**THE RHYTHM DIVINE** *(Top) 'River Raag' curated by Bickram Ghosh and (right) Usha Uthup in the 'Three Divas' performance from the 2024 festival*